

A cheat sheet for why AI isn't bad for the environment

Posted by u/cool_fox • • 0 points • 4 comments

<https://andymasley.substack.com/p/a-cheat-sheet-for-conversations-about>

- Personal use

A ChatGPT prompt uses too much energy/water

Energy

Water

ChatGPT is bad relative to other things we do (it's ten times as bad as a Google search)

ChatGPT uses enough energy that you should be very careful with how you use it. Don't use it as a search engine or a calculator or just to goof around

- Global use

Data centers are an environmental disaster. This shows that ChatGPT as a whole is using too much energy and we should boycott it

ChatGPT may not raise your own carbon footprint much, but it will be very bad for the environment if everyone starts using it

ChatGPT uses as much energy as 20,000 households

Training an AI model uses too much energy

- Other objections

This is all a gimmick anyway. Why not just use Google? ChatGPT doesn't give better information

Don't trust some random Substack post over scientific research

- Some other useful intuitions in conversations

AI companies don't want to give you free energy

It's 3 Wh!!!!

We should be focused on systematic change over individual lifestyles

Comments

u/Waste_Efficiency2029 • 10 points • 2025-04-30 07:35 UTC

I am more of an anti and actually appreciate this. The focus on criticising individual consumption for climate reasons isnt something i would anybody encourage to do. This wont help us and especially if it comes to climate problems we as regular people should stick together to fight the real threats

u/cool_fox • 4 points • 2025-04-30 07:52 UTC

Fully agree. We shouldn't let corporations or politicians off the hook

u/ronitrocket • 3 points • 2025-05-01 20:02 UTC

Push for open source alternatives. This is the most important time for AI's development and ironically a lot of the hate is only going to be affecting these models and not the private corporate ones.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-04-30 03:08 UTC

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u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-04-30 02:47 UTC

[removed]

u/AutoModerator • 3 points • 2025-04-30 02:47 UTC

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